GRAINS OF SAND

The Netherlands, September 18, 1944,
in the vicinity of Aalst.

On the eve of this day, the tanks of Lcl Vandeleur were still 10 kilometres distant from their goal, hence the Irish Guards are now back on the move.

Due to ferocious German resistance, the XXX Corps had not reached its objective to join up with the 101st Airborne within three hours.

The surrounding sand dunes and wooded areas somewhat compell the tanks to stick to the road. Scouts report that, close to Aalst at 5 kilometres of Eindhoven, Jerry has entrenched...



Composition of the armies :

Elements of the 2nd Irish Guard Armored Regiment



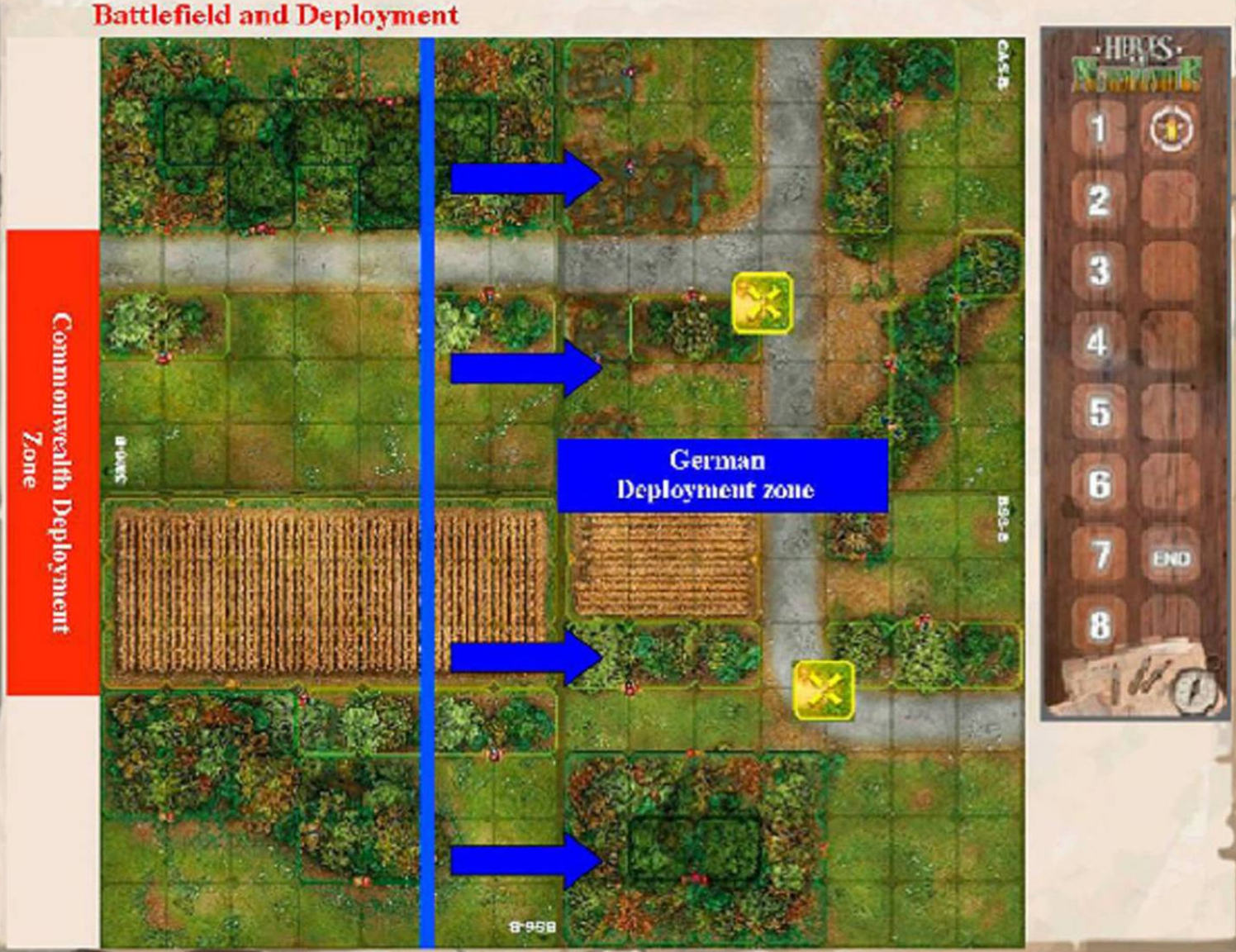






Elements of Fallschirmjäger Regiment 6

Battlefield and Deployment



Set up and Special Rules:

Remove all Artillery and Aviation cards from both decks.
Replace the Bren Carrier by a halftrack from the Winnipeg punchboard.
During deployment the German player :
-places all units before the Commonwealth player does
-receives a free defensive position to be placed within own zone
-may already apply concealment
Commonwealth player starts with initiative, place appropriate markers on the turn track.
Each player draws 4 cards.

Victory Conditions and Particular Information :

The Commonwealth player wins if 12 points are obtained by the end of the scenario.
Each objective under control is worth 3 VP.
Objective counters aren't removed after control is gained.
Players need not keep a unit present to preserve control over the objective but
an unguarded tile is easier to capture for the opponent, of course.
At the start of the game both objectives are under German contol.
Each heavy vehicle leaving the board on the east side of BS3-B is worth 5 VP
Each halftrack and infantry unit leaving the board on the east side of BS3-B is worth 1 VP

Epilogue :

Suddenly, from the edge of the woods alongside the road, heavy fire hit the column. An antitank gun opened up on the tanks who where confined to the road. The Allied infantry jumped off the vehicles to respond at once.

The attackers were elements of Fallschirmjäger Regiment 6, having received replacements for their heavy losses sustained during the fighting in Normandy. One of the best units Kurt Student, commander of the 1 Fallschirm Armee, could throw at XXX Corps.

Even though this scrap was quickly settled, this and similar actions significantly bogged down the advance of the Irish who didn't reach Eindhoven and the American 506th PIR until late on September 18.
Operation Market Garden with its very tight schedule had gotten off to a bad start.

Requirements :

-Core Box
-Battleground Set
-CW Army Box
-Canadian Inf. Pln.
-Ste Mère-Eglise
Scenario Pack
-Carentan
Scenario Pack

